SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #7 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

"My worth depends on staying wealthy."

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Where it often comes from

When a family, a profession, or a social circle measures people by what they own, we can learn that value equals net worth. A parent's approval may have followed achievement, or a past loss may have made money feel like the only protection against shame. Over time the account balance can become a report card on the person.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, "Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions." Scripture says we are fearfully and wonderfully made, and Paul tells the rich not to be conceited or to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Worth is a gift from our Creator, not a number we maintain. It cannot be raised by gain or lowered by loss.

> *"And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"* (Luke 12:15).

Also see

> "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life" (1 Timothy 6:17–19).

> "He who trusts in his riches will fall, but the righteous will thrive like foliage" (Proverbs 11:28).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?" (Mark 8:36).

Common self-statements

- If I lost my money, I would be nothing.
- I am only as valuable as my portfolio.
- People respect me because of what I have.
- I cannot stop earning or I will fall apart.
- Without wealth I would have no identity.
- Rest is for people who have not made it.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling secure when the numbers are high and worthless when they drop.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either successful or a failure.
- Labeling: Calling myself a "winner" or "loser" based on money.
- Fortune telling: Assuming that losing wealth would mean losing everyone's respect.

Challenging questions

- What did I learn about worth growing up, and from whom?

- If my finances changed tomorrow, what about me would remain?
- What does God say my worth is based on?
- Who loves me whether or not I have money?
- What do I do to keep my balance high that is costing me peace?
- What would it look like to receive my value as a gift?

Truth summary

> My worth was settled by God when He made me and by Christ when He died for me. It does not rise with my income or fall with my losses. I can steward wealth well and enjoy it, but I do not need it to prove that I matter.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Money
- Worldly
- Riches, Beware of
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My worth depends on staying wealthy"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My worth depends on staying wealthy." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn that wealth equals worth?
- ☐ What would remain if my money were gone?
- ☐ What does God say about my value?
- ☐ Who loves me apart from my money?
- ☐ What am I doing to protect my balance that costs me peace?
- ☐ What is one way to rest in my worth today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am valuable because God made me.
- ☐ My worth does not go up or down with my balance.
- ☐ I can enjoy wealth without needing it.
- ☐ My hope is in God, not in money.
- ☐ I can rest without losing my value.
- ☐ Christ's love is the one thing that cannot be lost.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 12:15**
  "And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"
- ☐ **1 Timothy 6:17–19**
  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:14**
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Worth check: Each day, write one thing that has value in you that has nothing to do with money, and note your peace from 0 to 10.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 12:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My life is more than my possessions, and I am valued by God.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Riches, Beware of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write "not for sale" qualities. List five things that are true of you that money cannot buy or take away.
- [ ] Take a planned break. Spend a half day away from checking accounts or earnings and notice how it feels.
- [ ] Tell a trusted person. Share where you have been tying your worth to money and ask for their view.
- [ ] Read the verse aloud. Say Luke 12:15 or Psalm 139:14 each morning for a week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My worth depends on staying wealthy": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Worth received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My worth depends on staying wealthy.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You made me and You know me. Free me from measuring myself by what I own. Help me hold wealth with open hands and rest in the worth You have already given me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.